

HYE IN (KATE) KWON

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CURRENT ACADEMIC & SERVICE APPOINTMENT

Instructor & Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Georgia (UGA)	2021 - Present
Advisor, UGA Girls' Club: Women in Sport Chapter	2024 - Present

EDUCATION

Ph.D., University of Georgia, Athens, GA Kinesiology (Sport Management & Policy) Qualifying Exam Passed Spring 2026 Dissertation Committee: Drs. Becca Leopkey (Chair), Henry Wear, Dana Ellis and Melissa Freeman	2027 (expected)
M.S., University of Georgia, Athens, GA Kinesiology (Sport Management & Policy)	2023
B.PEd., Kookmin University, Seoul, South Korea Physical Education (Sport Industry & Leisure)	2018

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Sport organizations; Organizational & Institutional theory; Digital transformation; Strategy; Risk management

PUBLICATIONS (PEER-REVIEWED)

- Kwon, H. I., Leopkey, B. (2025). Understanding interorganizational relationships in merged sport organizations. *Managing Sport and Leisure*, 1–17. <https://doi.org/10.1080/23750472.2025.2482263> (ABDC: B)
- Kwon, H. I., Ellis, D., Leopkey, B. “Digital Transformation in Sport Events.” In the Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Sport and Exercise. Ed. Steven Murray. New York: Oxford University Press, forthcoming.
doi: 10.1093/acrefore/9780197791295.013.ORE_SPE-00117.R1

PUBLICATIONS UNDER REVIEW

Kwon, H. I., Leopkey, B., Ellis, D., Church, T. Navigating a System-Wide Takeover in a Multi-Level Sport System: The Case of the MiLB Teams Under the Professional Development League. *Sport, Business and Management: An International Journal* (ABDC: B). *Major Revision*

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

- Leopkey, B., Kwon, H. I., Ellis, D., Dowling, M. Navigating the AI Paradigm Shift: Analyzing the Adoption of Artificial Intelligence in National Sport Governing Bodies in the United States. *Final Write Stage*
- Kwon, H. I., Leopkey, B. Initiating Digital Transformation in the Olympic Movement: A Dynamic Capabilities Perspective. *Data Collection & Preliminary Analysis Stage*
- Kwon, H. I., Leopkey, B. From Strategy to Practice: Translating Digital Transformation Initiatives within the Organizing Committees. *Data Collection & Preliminary Analysis Stage*
- Kwon, H. I., Leopkey, B. Knowledge Management and External Transfer of Digital Transformation Across the Olympic Games. *Data Collection & Preliminary Analysis Stage*
- Kwon, H. I., Anderson, B., Leopkey, B., Baker, T. Navigating Labor Changes: Managerial Perspectives on Governance Adaptations in Minor League Baseball.

REFEREED PRESENTATIONS (*denotes the presenter)

*Kwon, H., Leopkey, B., Ellis, D., Dowling, M. (May 2026). Navigating the AI Paradigm Shift: Analyzing the Adoption of Artificial Intelligence in National Sport Governing Bodies in the United States. Paper presented at the 2026 North American Society for Sport Management, San Juan, PR.

*Kwon, H., Leopkey, B., Ellis, D. (June 2024). Reshaping the League: The Evolution of Minor League Baseball in the 'One Baseball' Era. Paper presented at the 2024 NASSM, Minneapolis, MN.

*Kwon, H., Leopkey, B. (September 2022). Understanding Interorganizational Relationships in Merged Sport Organizations. Paper presented at the 30th European Association for Sport Management (EASM) Conference, Innsbruck, Austria.

*Kwon, H., Biedermann, P., Pietras, P., Herber, A., te Strake, F. (September 2022). Tyrolean Community Festival: More than just a state for tourists. Presented at the 30th EASM Conference, Innsbruck, Austria.

****Winner of the 2022 EASM Student Sport Management Competition**

CONSORTIA & WORKSHOPS

Sport Management Doctoral Colloquium, Baton Rouge, LA, 2025

Student Workshop, 2024 NASSM Conference, Minneapolis, MN, 2024

Student Seminar, 30th EASM Conference, Innsbruck, Austria, 2022.

TEACHING INTERESTS

Sport event management, Sport marketing, Strategic management, Risk management, Organizational theory & behavior, Qualitative methods

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, University of Georgia, Athens, GA

2021- Present

KINS 4840 - Sport Event Management

PEDB 1380/90 - Beginner/Intermediate Volleyball (16/3 sessions)

PEDB 1950/E - FFL Walking/Online Walking (10/4 sessions)

PEDB 1930 - FFL Jogging (2 sessions)

PEDB 1090 - Outdoor Adventure (3 sessions)

***Overall instructor rating: 4.7/5.00**

***Received 2025 UGA Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award**

Invited Lectures

KINS 7270 Sport Events Management (Graduate level) (2 sessions)

KINS 4840 Sport Events Management (10 sessions)

KINS 3430 Introduction to Sport Management (4 sessions)

FYOS 1001 First-year Odyssey (6 sessions)

FIELDWORK EXPERIENCE

Greenberg Traurig, LLP

Atlanta, GA

Case Clerk / Research Intern

2024

- Organized and analyzed litigation data to ensure accuracy and accessibility
- Assisted in legal research by collecting and summarizing archival data for two projects

Seoul Sports Council

Seoul, South Korea

Assistant Manager, Sports Events Team & Support Division

2019 - 2020

- Received the Seoul City Mayor's Award for successfully hosting the 100th National Sports Festival
- Collaborated in teams of up to 8,000 staff and volunteers to organize the 100th National Sports Festival, 2019 National Sports-for-all Festival, and the 49th National Youth Sports Festival
- Co-managed a budget and expenditures of approximately \$11 million to uphold team's fiscal responsibility

- Supervised 47 Provincial Sport Federations and 25 Municipal Sport Councils for effective organization and management of sport events
- Collaborated with the Korea Anti-Doping Agency to coordinate doping control for over 20,000 athletes
- Managed approximately 6,000 volunteers in partnership with the Seoul Volunteer Center

PyeongChang Organizing Committee for the 2018 Winter Olympic Games

Gangwon, South Korea

Sport Assistant, Freestyle Ski & Snowboard Team

2017 - 2018

- Assisted in managing the overall logistics of 18 Freestyle Ski & Snowboard Olympic events, including organizing Team Captain Meetings, developing contingency plans, and overseeing slope construction
- Led two teams of 20 volunteers each to ensure their effective participation and support

AWARDS

2026 UGA College of Education General Scholarship (Total: \$1,250)	2026
2025 UGA Mary Ella Lunday Soule Scholarship Award (Research Award)	2025 - 2026
2025 UGA Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award	2025
2022 EASM Student Award	2022
Seoul Metropolitan City Mayor's Award	2019
Kookmin University College of Physical Education Scholarship	2014
Kookmin University Entrance Fellowship (Type D)	2014

EXTERNAL GRANTS

2027 IOC Olympic Studies Centre, PhD and Early Career Academics Research Grant Program	2026
<i>Status: Application submitted</i>	

TRAVEL GRANTS

UGA Department of Kinesiology Travel Award (Total: \$1,950)	2022, 2024, 2025
UGA Sport Management Fund Student Travel Award (Total: \$1,000)	2024, 2025

SERVICE & AFFILIATIONS

Advisor, UGA Girls' Club: Women in Sport Chapter	2024 - Present
Graduate Teaching Assistant Mentor, UGA Basic Physical Education Program	2021 - Present
Industry Relations & Partnerships Committee Student Representative, NASSM	2024 - 2025
Moderator, UGA Annual Global Educational Forum	2022 - 2025
Member, UGA Beach Volleyball Club	2024
Moderator, 2024 NASSM Conference	2024

REVIEWER ACTIVITY

Managing Sport and Leisure (Since 2023)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

North American Society for Sport Management
European Association for Sport Management
Korean American Society for Sport Management

REFERENCES

Dr. Becca Leopkey Professor Department of Kinesiology University of Georgia bleopkey@uga.edu +1 706-202-7874	Dr. Henry Wear Assistant Professor Department of Kinesiology University of Georgia henry.wear@uga.edu +1 541-870-7125	Dr. Dana Ellis Associate Professor School of Sports Administration Laurentian University dellis@laurentian.ca +1 705-202-9967
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